AMIRMAHDI SHOKATABADI

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EDUCATION

Utrecht University *Sept 2023 - Aug 2024*
M.Sc. in Banking and Finance, GPA: 7.11/10.0
Relevant coursework: Asset Pricing, Empirical Economics, Sustainable Finance, Financial Data Analytics, Algorithms in Finance, Risk Management in Financial Institutions

Kharazmi University *Sept 2018 - July 2022*
B.Sc. in Financial Management, GPA: 3.57/4.0 (Last two years: 3.7/4.0)
Related courses: Mathematics, Statistics, Operations Research, Econometrics, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics

Online maths: Linear Algebra (Johns Hopkins, Coursera); Differential and Integral Calculus (LSE, edX)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Climate and sustainable finance, Empirical asset pricing, Behavioral finance, Applied econometrics

MASTER'S THESIS (WRITING SAMPLE)

Warming Trends: Do Local Temperature Anomalies Affect the Returns and Volatility of US Firms?
Studied whether unusually hot or cold months at a firm's headquarters move its stock returns. Built a panel of 17,075 US firms and 1.86 million firm-months from Compustat (WRDS, 1995–2024) and matched 1,977 headquarters cities to 4 km PRISM climate data, measuring each month's temperature against its 30-year local average. Panel regressions with firm and industry-by-month fixed effects find no effect on returns: the 95% confidence interval rules out effects above about 7 basis points per month for a one standard deviation anomaly (about 3°F). The result holds for heat-sensitive industries, warmer and colder places, lags, and other fixed effects and baselines.

Supervisor: *Dr. Thomas Walther* June 2024 (revised as a working paper Oct 2026), Utrecht University

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Independent Research Project: Extending the Thesis (paused)

- Began extending my thesis to compare how developed and emerging markets price temperature shocks. Collected stock and firm data and geocoded firm addresses from 10-K filings with OpenStreetMap in Python.

Advisor: *Dr. Fatemeh Salimi* April 2025 - Sept 2025

Research Assistant (volunteer)

- Contributed to RiskLabAI, an open-source Python library for financial machine learning based on López de Prado (*pip install RiskLabAI*); implemented modules for data structures, labeling and sample weighting.

Supervisor: *Dr. Hamid Arian* Aug 2024 - Dec 2024, RiskLab (remote)

Research Assistant

- Built and cleaned large datasets in Python for a research project on biodiversity risk in financial markets.

Supervisor: *Dr. Thomas Walther* July 2024 - Aug 2024, Utrecht University

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Financial Product Owner, Portfolio Performance and Risk - Mofid Securities June 2026 - Present

- Choose and test the methods for return and risk measures (time- and money-weighted returns, volatility, historical VaR, maximum drawdown, Sharpe ratio, beta) for portfolios of Easy Trader's 7 million users.
- Check results in SQL and Python; tracing edge cases cut money-weighted return errors by over 50%.

Financial Data and Risk Analyst - Damavand Investment Bank

- Estimated risk for three fixed-income funds (VaR by historical simulation and Monte Carlo, Expected Shortfall, duration), and stock betas and factor models for the Iranian market.
- Built and validated a dataset of all Iranian mutual funds and their holdings from web scraping and APIs.

Supervisor: *Dr. Fatemeh Salimi* Jan 2025 - Feb 2026

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Blended Finance Mechanisms for Climate Action June 2024, Utrecht University
Co-developed two case studies on blended finance, where public or philanthropic money is used to mobilise private capital, applied to sustainable development and climate resilience projects.

Textual Data Sentiment Analysis June 2024, Utrecht University
Measured the polarity (negative to positive) and subjectivity (factual to opinion) of CNBC news articles about Donald Trump, using natural language processing in Python with the spaCy package.

Option High-Frequency Trading April 2024, Utrecht University
Built a market-making algorithm in Python that traded options using option Greeks and high-frequency data, in the course Algorithms in Finance run with Optiver. Our team came second in the Optiver Algo-Competition.

Relative Value Spread Trading Feb 2024, Utrecht University
Statistical arbitrage strategy in Python: tested pairs of assets for cointegration with the Engle–Granger method and traded the spread when it moved away from its long-run relation.

Bitcoin and Gold as Geopolitical Hedge Instruments Jan 2024, Utrecht University
Empirical evaluation of Bitcoin and gold as hedging instruments against geopolitical risk, using time-series methods to compare how the two assets respond when geopolitical risk rises.

Risk Management Jan 2024, Utrecht University
Interest-rate risk with an alternative principal component analysis (PCA). Market risk with Value-at-Risk, calculated both by the historical method and by the model-building approach.

Impact of Mergers and Acquisitions in the US Tech Industry Nov 2023, Utrecht University
Event study of how M&A announcements affect the abnormal stock returns of US tech firms around the announcement date, using standard asset pricing methodology.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, "Financial AI"

- Built Python notebooks for the course on preparing raw market data for machine learning models.
- Wrote functions for tick, volume and dollar bars, triple-barrier labels and uniqueness-based sample weights.

Supervisor: *Dr. Hamid Arian* Sept 2024 - Dec 2024, University of Toronto (remote)

Teaching Assistant, "Fundamentals of Investment Management"

- Asked the lecturer for the role myself as a final-year undergraduate, and led weekly tutorials for 40 students.
- Wrote practice questions and problem sets, prepared teaching materials, and graded assignments.

Supervisor: *Dr. Saeidi Kousha* Jan 2022 - March 2022, Kharazmi University

HONORS AND AWARDS

Second place (team), Optiver Algo-Competition April 2024, Utrecht University

Top 1% in Iran's national university entrance exam Summer 2018, Iran
Ranked 686 of about 200,000 candidates; full scholarship for the bachelor's degree.

SKILLS

Programming	Python (pandas, NumPy, statsmodels, linearmodels, scikit-learn, spaCy), SQL, Julia
Econometrics	Panel data, time series, cointegration, event studies, PCA, Monte Carlo simulation, Stata
Data	WRDS (Compustat), PRISM climate data, SEC filings, web scraping and APIs
Tools	Git/GitHub, LaTeX, Power BI, Excel; AI-assisted coding (Claude Code, Cursor)
Languages	Persian (native), English (fluent), Dutch (beginner)

REFERENCES

Dr. Thomas Walther
Associate Professor of Finance
Utrecht University

Dr. Fatemeh Salimi
Assistant Professor of Economics
Tarbiat Modares University